

Romain Sickenberg

Backend-Software Engineer

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Backend-oriented Software Engineer with 5+ years of professional experience building and maintaining business-critical web applications with PHP, Symfony, Laravel, React and Docker.

Hands-on experience in CI/CD optimizations, code reviews, production deployments and technical leadership of medium-sized projects.

Work authorization: Swiss Citizen. Available now.

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Software Developer

03.2024 - 12.2025

Academic Work SA

IT Consulting for diverse clients via Academic Work.

- Developed full-stack web applications using Vue (Nuxt.JS) & Backend in Python (Django) for the SIL in Lausanne.
 - Built a React (Next.JS) application with GitHub Actions CI/CD, Docker containerization and automated deployments to Jelastic.
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Security Agent

07.2023 - 03.2024

Securitas AG

Part-time security agent in the event sector.

Solo World Travel & Personal Development

02.2023 - 06.2023

Personal Break

Planned career break: Solo travel and personal development.

Backend Software Engineer

10.2021 - 01.2023

Antistatique SA

From Junior to mid-level Software Engineer & highest skill jump !

- Developed and maintained enterprise Symfony 6 applications, using PHP 7.4/8.0, API Platform, Doctrine ORM, PostgreSQL and GitHub Actions.
- Involved as PHP Lead Developer for a client project in Symfony with 4 other devs.
- Built and maintained CMS-based solutions (Drupal, WordPress).
- Reduced GitHub Actions execution time by 75% through dependency caching and workflow optimization.
- Deployed projects to production using structured deployment processes.
- Led code reviews to improve maintainability and enforce development standards.
- Collaborated within a multidisciplinary development team using Scrum.
- Took technical responsibility for small to medium-sized projects.
- Managed and optimized local development environments using Docker and modern IDE tooling.
- Analyzed project requirements and contributed to technical estimations.

Junior Backend Software Engineer

02.2021 - 10.2021

Ilem Group

IT Consulting to an external client named Berdoz Vision & Audition.

- Secured a custom highly critical ERP, migrated it to a newer PHP version and contributed to the development of its Laravel replacement.
- Configured a fleet of 44 iPads and set up CI servers to run complex test suites with Codeception and Cypress.
- Improved security and developed critical components of existing in-house CRM solution for multiple shops around Switzerland.
- Built internal tools for automated testing, monitoring, and deployment, while ensuring high-quality standards with Sentry.

Swiss Armed Forces

07.2020 - 11.2020

Personal Break

Mandatory obligations.

Apprentice Software Engineer

06.2016 - 06.2020

Liip AG

Started my IT career while studying 2 days per week at school.

- Developed and enhanced internal web applications using PHP and JavaScript.
- Collaborated within an Agile development team using Git and modern web development practices.
- Developed custom Moodle plugins with PHP 5.4.
- Used Scrum in an Holacratic environment.

SKILLS

BACKEND

PHP, Python, Node.js, C#, Java

FRONTEND

TypeScript & JavaScript, React, Next.js, Nuxt.js, NPM & Bun, HTML5 & CSS, Sass, Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js

LOWER LEVEL

Swift 5 (iOS, WatchOS, Combine, Intents, Swift UI, etc.)

DATABASES

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Prisma / Supabase, Redis

CLOUD & DEVOPS

Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Linux, Apache & Nginx, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS, Serverless

TOOLS

Git, Composer, Jira, Confluence & Scrum, Rest APIs, Sentry, Bash

EDUCATION

Swiss Confederation | EPSIC @ Lausanne & CFPT @ Geneva

08.2016 - 07.2020

Federal VET Diploma in Information Technology (CFC)

GPA: 4.4

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Publishing a website, Data modeling, Coding, compression and encryption systems, Object-oriented programming principles, Graphical interfaces for applications, Automation tasks, Scripting and procedure automation, Client-side web development, Interactive web pages, Object-oriented component design, Data structures and algorithms, Agile software development, SQL databases, Session handling in web applications, Database integration into web applications, Application deployment, Application security

PROJECTS

Tesla Companion

01.2018 - 01.2023

Paid iOS & WatchOS App to work around Tesla cars.

- Built and published a commercial iOS and watchOS application integrating Tesla APIs reaching over 1,000 daily active users and ranking #5 in the App Store Trips category.

Fort-To-Nite

01.2017 - 01.2019

Free iOS wiki around Fortnite with live in-game shop indications and Django back-end.

- Fortnite companion app with 100,000+ downloads, 4.6* rating (340+ reviews) and a peak ranking of #19 in the App Store Reference category.

AWARDS

EPFL Hackathon AR/VR Game Experiences

12.2019 - 12.2019

RA \ VR Hackathon

Built a "digital museum" in Virtual reality. Won the first place in VR experiences, built with SteamVR and Unity.

LANGUAGES

French — Native

English — Fluent (C2)

German — Intermediate (B1)

INTERESTS

Video Games, Movies, Music

PC Gamer

Sci-Fi

House

Travel

Backpacking

Solo Adventures

Photography

Drone

DSLR

Astro-photography